Mom's Monthly Income, Source by Source

A worksheet to fill in together, from her paperwork instead of from memory.

Most families can say “Social Security and a pension.” Fewer can say which pension, how it arrives, and where the letter about it is kept.

Fill this in with Mom, one source at a time. For each one, write who pays it, how it arrives, the amount as the paperwork shows it, and where that paperwork is. If you don't know, write “don't know yet” and leave it.

No account numbers, Social Security numbers or passwords need to go on this page.

Social Security

What Mom receives, how it reaches her, and where the letter or statement that shows the amount is kept. If the amount on the letter and the amount that reaches the bank are different, write both and say which is which.

FOR EXAMPLE Direct deposit into the credit union checking account, around the middle of the month. Amount copied from the letter in the blue folder, hall desk.

Pensions and retirement distributions

Each pension, and any regular payment from a retirement account. Write who pays it, if the paperwork or the bank statement says.

FOR EXAMPLE Pension from the school district, monthly, same checking account. Mom thinks a second, smaller one comes from an old employer. Neither of us knows who pays it. Look at the bank statement together.

Annuity, rental and employment income

Regular payments from an annuity, rent from a property or a room, and pay from any work she still does. Leave this blank if none of them apply.

FOR EXAMPLE Rents the apartment over the garage to a neighbor, who pays by check on the first. We haven't found a lease on paper.

Other income

Anything else that arrives regularly and isn't written above. If you aren't sure whether something counts as income, write it here anyway and keep the question for a professional.

FOR EXAMPLE A small deposit every three months. Mom says it's from some shares her brother left her. No statement found yet.

What we couldn't confirm

Sources Mom mentions that have no paperwork yet, and deposits on a statement that nobody can name. Don't guess.

FOR EXAMPLE A deposit on the March statement with only initials beside it. Mom will ask the bank what it is.

Who filled this in, and the date

What this shows you

Three things: each source of Mom's income, how it arrives and where its paperwork is, and the sources you still need to look for. The page stops at the list. It doesn't add anything up, and it doesn't show what Mom has available to pay for care or what any of it means for Medicaid. Rules vary by state, and those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down each source of Mom's income from the paperwork instead of from memory. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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